Population increases when there are more births and immigration. It decreases when there are more deaths and emigration. Population growth, can be calculated as



The **black death** is estimated to have killed 30 - 60 percent of Europe's total population during the 14th century. The dominant explanation for black death is attributed to the outbreak of plague.

6.2.2 Distribution of Population

Population distribution refers to the way in which people are spread out across the earth's surface.

The world population is not uniformly distributed, owing to the following factors.

a). Physical Factors

Physical factors include temperature, rainfall, soil, relief, water, natural vegetation, distribution of minerals and availability of energy resources.

b). Historical Factors

Regions with historical importance (river valley civilizations), war and constant invasions fall under historical factors responsible for population distribution.

c). Economic Factors

Educational institutions, employment opportunities, manufacturing industries, luxurious amenities, trade and commerce and other facilities encourage dense population in an area.



The World Population Day is observed on 11th July every year. It seeks to raise awareness of global population issues. The United Nations Development Programme started celebrating this event from the year 1989.

6.2.3 Density of Population

Density of population refers to the number of people living per square kilometre. An area is said to be sparsely populated when it has a large area with less number of people. Similarly, smaller the area with a large number of people, it is said to be densely populated.

$$\text{Population Density} = \frac{\text{Total Population}}{\text{Total land area}}$$

The world's population density is divided into three main groups.

- Areas of high density (above 50 people per sq.km) - East Asia, South Asia, North West Europe & Eastern North America.
- Areas of moderate density (10 to 50 people per sq.km) - The sub tropical regions like Angola, Congo, Nigeria and Zambia in Africa.
- Areas of low density (less than 10 people per sq.km) - Central Africa, Western Australia, Northern Russia, Canada, etc…

Activity

The population data of the five most densely populated districts of Tamil Nadu is given below. (Findout the population density and their rank)

District	Area (square km)	Population (2011 census)	Population Density	Rank
Chennai	178.2	46,46,732		
Kanchipuram	7857	39,98,252		
Vellore	6077	39,36,331		
Thiruvallur	3424	37,28,104		
Salem	5205	34,82,056		

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